■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Thursday, September 10, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *New York’s loneliest county ranked by number of sad singles — and it’s bad news for The Bronx*

The Angle: *A new study says the Bronx — home to Yankee Stadium, the Bronx Zoo, and 1.4 million people — is actually New York's loneliest county, which is a fun contradiction that plays into the bigger 'loneliness epidemic' conversation everyone's having right now.*

- **The Bronx** was just ranked New York's most lonely county in a new study
- The borough has a population of over **1.4 million people**
- It's home to major hubs like **Yankee Stadium** and the **Bronx Zoo** — spots built for crowds, not solitude
- The irony: one of NYC's busiest boroughs is topping the loneliness list

The Debate Starter

- Does population size even matter when it comes to loneliness, or can you feel isolated in the middle of 1.4 million people?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/10/us-news/nycs-loneliest-county-revealed-new-study/

■ *Why ‘uncomfortable’ Sydney Sweeney approached prediction market to strip down for viral ad*

The Angle: *A Hollywood A-lister fronting a prediction-market ad right before NFL kickoff is a wild crossover moment, and the fact Sweeney admits she felt "uncomfortable" doing it only fuels the buzz.*

- **Sydney Sweeney** teamed up with prediction market **Novig** for a viral ad campaign.
- Sweeney reportedly said she felt **"uncomfortable"** when she approached the brand about stripping down for the spot.
- The partnership lands right as prediction markets are ramping up marketing ahead of the **NFL season**.
- It's being called one of the more surprising celebrity pairings to come out of the prediction-market world this year.

The Debate Starter

- Celebrities selling betting markets before kickoff - smart marketing or a line that shouldn't be crossed?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/10/sports/why-uncomfortable-sydney-sweeney-approached-prediction-market-to-strip-down-for-viral-ad/

■ *Kimmel says his interview with James Talarico will NOT air on ABC tomorrow. Trump’s FCC has threatened him, his show, ABC, its affiliates, and local stations. He says the full interview will instead be posted to YouTube: "In the America we live now, that is the best that we can do until November."*

The Angle: *A late-night host says government pressure is keeping an interview off broadcast TV entirely — that's a press-freedom flashpoint, not just showbiz gossip, and it lands right as the Kimmel-ABC saga keeps escalating.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel** says his sit-down with Texas lawmaker **James Talarico** will NOT air on **ABC**

- He claims **Trump's FCC** has threatened him personally, his show, **ABC**, and local affiliates
- The full interview is instead being dumped straight to **YouTube**
- His line on it: **"In the America we live now, that is the best that we can do until November."

The Debate Starter

- Is this a host dodging censorship, or a host manufacturing a martyr moment — and does it matter which if the audience just watches on YouTube anyway?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/pnkrt30gdmoh1

■ *Ella Langley Leads 2026 CMA Awards Nominations With Nine, as Miranda Lambert, Kacey Musgraves Also Score Big Tallies*

The Angle: *The CMA nominations just dropped and Ella Langley is having a moment — she's one nod away from tying a record that's stood since 2002, and she's got Miranda Lambert and Kacey Musgraves right behind her. It's a great country-music underdog-to-frontrunner story for the morning.*

- **Ella Langley** led all 2026 CMA nominees with **nine nominations**.
- That's just one shy of the all-time single-year record, set by **Alan Jackson** back in **2002**.
- **Miranda Lambert** pulled in the second-most nominations this year.
- **Kacey Musgraves** also posted a big tally in Thursday morning's announcement.

The Debate Starter

- Who's your pick to actually win big this year — Ella Langley's breakout or Miranda Lambert's veteran pull?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/music/news/cma-awards-nominations-ella-langley-leads-2026-miranda-kacey-1236856514/

■ *LG strongly denies TV spying claims, says tracking and snooping concerns 'not true' — online investigation claims 216,000,000 TVs spy and record audio*

The Angle: *This hits almost everyone in the audience — most people have a smart TV in their living room, and the idea that it might be secretly listening or watching is exactly the kind of creeping tech-paranoia story that gets phones ringing.*

- A viral online investigation claims roughly **216 million LG TVs** are tracking users and recording audio
- **LG** is pushing back hard, calling the snooping and tracking claims **'not true'**
- The claims are circulating widely on **Reddit's r/technology**, fueling fresh smart-TV privacy fears
- No independent verification of the **216,000,000** figure has been confirmed yet — it's LG's word against the investigation's

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually believe your smart TV isn't listening — or have you already put tape over the camera?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/big-tech/lg-strongly-denies-tv-security-claims-says-tracking-and-snooping-concerns-not-true-online-investigation-claims-216-000-000-spy-tvs-record-audio

Backup options:

■ *Cops Are Using Flock to Spy on People for the Crime of Standing Around | Police scanned Flock cameras in a single town in Illinois more than 1,200 times to investigate cases of loitering*

The Angle: *This is the Flock camera surveillance story blowing up online right now — a genuinely unsettling look at how far AI license plate readers have crept into everyday policing, and it's a national privacy flashpoint, not a one-town quirk.*

- Police in a single Illinois town ran Flock camera searches more than **1,200 times** tied to loitering investigations.

- Flock cameras are marketed for solving serious crimes like car theft, but records show they're also being used for low-level, vague offenses like just "standing around."
- The report is fueling a bigger backlash over how widely AI surveillance networks are being used by local police departments without much public oversight.

The Debate Starter

- Where's the line between public safety and just being watched for existing in public?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://theintercept.com/2026/09/09/flock-cameras-police-loitering-curfew-surveillance/

■ *LG accused of tracking its smart TV users, scanning home networks, and recording conversations*

The Angle: *Millions of North Americans have an LG smart TV in their living room right now, and this story taps straight into the creeping fear that our own screens are watching and listening back.*

- **LG** is accused of tracking smart TV users' viewing habits and behavior
- Allegations include the TVs **scanning users' home networks**
- Claims also involve the devices **recording conversations** in the room

The Debate Starter

- Would you unplug or keep using your smart TV if you knew it was listening?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113777-lg-accused-tracking-smart-tv-users-scanning-home.html

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CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *In Ontario, Canada, national identity among white working-class voters has a strong association with the center-left Liberal Party and no association with racial resentment, religiosity and anti-government sentiment. This stands in contrast to similar voters across the border in the US Midwest.*

The Angle: *New research says white working-class pride in being Canadian tracks with supporting the Liberals — not grievance politics — while the same demographic in the US Midwest leans into resentment and anti-government anger. It's a real 'why are we so different up here' conversation starter.*

- Study looked at **Ontario's** white working-class voters and how strongly they identify as **Canadian**
- That national identity lines up with support for the center-left **Liberal Party** — not a right-wing populist one
- No link found to **racial resentment**, **religiosity**, or **anti-government sentiment**, unlike the pattern researchers see in the **US Midwest**
- Researchers are framing it as a straight-up contrast: same kind of voter, opposite political instincts depending which side of the border they're on

The Debate Starter

- Why does the exact same voter — working-class, small-town, patriotic — vote Liberal in Ontario but MAGA in Ohio?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/nana.70115

■ *The iPhone Duo Canadian Pricing Revealed: starts at $2,999*

The Angle: *Canadians are staring down another sticker-shock Apple launch, and the price tag is exactly the kind of "wait, how much?!" moment that gets people texting each other mid-scroll.*

- The new **iPhone Duo** lineup starts at **$2,999 CAD** for the top configuration.

- Canadian iPhone pricing routinely runs well above U.S. sticker prices once exchange rate and taxes are factored in.
- The price point is already fueling reaction threads on **r/canada**.

The Debate Starter

- Is $2,999 a phone you buy outright, or the moment you finally say no to Apple?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.iphoneincanada.ca/2026/09/09/iphone-duo-canadian-pricing-revealed-tops-5000-after-tax/

■■ *No longer taboo, Canada's defence industry steps into Europe's spotlight*

The Angle: *Canada is headlining one of Europe's biggest weapons expos as the continent rearms — a sign the country's defence sector is chasing new buyers and finally shedding its quiet, under-the-radar reputation.*

- Canada showed up as the **'lead nation'** at Poland's **MSPO arms fair**, one of Europe's largest defence expos.
- **230 Canadian firms** made the trip to pitch their gear.
- The push comes as Canada tries to break its long-standing reliance on the **American market** for defence sales.
- Framing shift: an industry that used to avoid the spotlight is now actively courting it.

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be leaning harder into the global arms trade, or is staying America-reliant the safer bet?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/canada-defence-industry-europe-9.7336763?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Canada's big banks embrace AI as workers face job uncertainty*

The Angle: *Canada's biggest banks are betting big on AI right as a new study says almost every finance job in the country could be touched by it - a real gut-check story for anyone with a mortgage broker, teller, or advisor in the family.*

- A **Toronto Metropolitan University** study found **98%** of financial sector workers are "highly exposed" to AI technologies.
- Despite that number, at least **one Canadian bank** says it still expects staff levels to **rise**.
- The story centers on how Canada's **big banks** are actively rolling out AI tools inside their operations.

The Debate Starter

- If AI touches 98% of bank jobs, are we automating away the teller line or just changing what "banker" means?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/canada-banks-ai-9.7337625?cmp=rss

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■■ *Community mourns woman who died in Cape Breton floods*

The Angle: *This is the human face of the storm that just tore through Atlantic Canada — a 46-year-old woman swept away trying to get home, and now a whole community is grieving. It matters because it turns a weather headline into a real person's story.*

- **Stephanie Comeau**, **46**, of **Richmond County, N.S.**, died during Saturday's storm
- She was reported **missing** before her body was found
- Her **vehicle** was located near a **flooded bridge**
- Community members in **Cape Breton** are now publicly mourning her loss

The Human Cost

- Behind every 'flash flood warning' graphic is a real family — take a beat here, this one's not a laugh-and-move-on story.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/nova-scotia/community-mourns-woman-who-died-in-cape-breton-floods-9.7337867?cmp=rss

■ *N.B. farmer honours Marie-Philip Poulin with corn maze | The Moment*

The Angle: *A P.E.I.-area farmer turned his field into a giant tribute to Montreal Victoire captain Marie-Philip Poulin - it's the kind of hyper-local, hyper-Canadian love letter that's basically tailor-made for a warm, feel-good segment.*

- Farmer **Chip Hunter** cut a corn maze shaped like **Marie-Philip Poulin's** face into his land in **Florenceville-Bristol, N.B.**
- **Poulin** is the captain of the **Montreal Victoire** in the PWHL.
- **Hunter** told **CBC's The National** about the moment and process of designing the tribute.

The Feel-Good Fuel

- Who deserves a corn maze in their honor next - which Canadian athlete would you carve into a field?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7338221?cmp=rss

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■■ *Jimmy Kimmel reveals interview with rising Democratic star won’t air on ABC amid FCC threats*

The Angle: *Kimmel's had real run-ins with the FCC before, so a claim that a network is spiking an interview over regulatory pressure taps right into the free-speech-vs-censorship fight everyone's already primed to argue about.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel** says he taped an interview with a rising **Democratic** star
- He claims **ABC** won't air it
- Kimmel points to **FCC** threats as the reason

The Debate Starter

- Is this network caution or actual political pressure shaping what you're allowed to see — phone lines, weigh in.

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/arts-entertainment/tv/news/jimmy-kimmel-james-talarico-interview-fcc-b3047879.html

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■ *Watch This! ROSÉ Teases ‘New Trick’ Song & Music Video: Here’s When It Arrives*

The Angle: *The BLACKPINK star is teasing a surprise new single and video, giving K-pop and pop fans something fresh to hunt down clues about before it drops.*

The Tease Test

- Callers: are you actually clicking the link to guess the release date, or waiting for the drop?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2097935627039736204

■ *Penélope Cruz Sobs and Kisses Javier Bardem as ‘Bunker’ Dazzles Venice With Record 15.5-Minute Ovation*

The Angle: *This isn't just a movie premiere reaction - Cruz and Bardem are real-life spouses, so watching her break down in his arms on stage is the kind of raw, unscripted celebrity moment that clips travel fast.*

- **"Bunker"** premiered at the **Venice Film Festival**
- The crowd gave it a reported **15.5-minute standing ovation** - a new record for the fest
- **Penélope Cruz** was seen in tears, kissing co-star and real-life husband **Javier Bardem**
- Cruz and Bardem are one of Hollywood's most private long-term couples, rarely this emotional in public

The Reaction Bit

- Would you want cameras on you crying that hard in front of a room full of strangers - even for a standing ovation?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/festivals/penelope-cruz-javier-bardem-bunker-venice-premiere-1236844863/

■ *Suki Waterhouse Says She'd Be 'Nepo-Babying' Her Daughter With Robert Pattinson If She Wanted to Work in Hollywood*

The Angle: *Nepotism babies are one of Hollywood's favorite fights right now, and Suki Waterhouse just waded into it herself, admitting that pushing her daughter with Robert Pattinson into acting would be exactly that.*

- **Suki Waterhouse** says she'd be **"nepo-babying"** her daughter if she steered her into show business.
- The daughter's father is **Robert Pattinson**, giving the kid A-list pedigree on both sides.
- The comment plays directly into the ongoing **"nepo baby"** debate that's dogged Hollywood's next generation.

The Debate Starter

- Is it actually possible for a celebrity kid to "make it" in Hollywood without the nepo-baby label following them forever?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/suki-waterhouse-robert-pattinson-nepo-baby-daughter-1236856866/

Backup options:

■ *Theo James "If my grandfather were alive today, he would be sounding a warning. I sound the warning on his behalf. To remind people that becoming a refugee can happen to any of us at any time. The right to seek safety was a promise made for us all, and that promise needs protecting and defending."*

The Angle: *The Divergent and White Lotus star is using his celebrity platform to speak out on refugee rights, tying it to his own family history - a good jumping-off point for a talk about when celebrity advocacy lands and when it doesn't.*

- **Theo James** says **"if my grandfather were alive today, he would be sounding a warning"** on refugees.
- He frames himself as sounding that warning **"on his behalf."**
- His core message: **"becoming a refugee can happen to any of us at any time."**
- He calls the right to seek safety **"a promise made for us all"** that **"needs protecting and defending."**

The Debate Starter

- When a star gets personal and political like this, does it move the needle for you or feel like a PR moment?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wbsbr8

■ *Hasan Piker appears on the big screen at the Republican midterm convention in Dallas for... reasons*

The Angle: *A famously left-wing Twitch streamer's face showing up on the big screen at a Republican convention in Dallas is the kind of only-in-2026 political-internet crossover that's built for confused screenshots and 'wait, what happened' chatter.*

- **Hasan Piker** — the left-leaning **Twitch** megastar — appeared on the big screen at the **Republican midterm convention** in **Dallas**.
- The reported reason why is murky at best — early chatter just says 'for... reasons.'

The Debate Starter

- Troll, mistake, or bit — why do you think a GOP crowd got a face-to-face with Hasan Piker on the jumbotron?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/jbarrrsz0loh1.jpeg

■ *TIFF's at a turning point — but how will the film festival's new focus on dealmaking affect fans?*

The Angle: *Canada's biggest film festival turns 51 and is quietly rebranding itself as a dealmaking hub instead of a premiere destination — and with ticket prices climbing too, fans are asking if TIFF is losing its cool.*

- This year is **TIFF's 51st edition**, and organizers are leaning into it as a business marketplace, not just a red-carpet showcase.
- Other festivals have been **snagging the buzzy world premieres** that used to be TIFF's bread and butter.
- The festival is repositioning itself as a hotspot for **making movie deals** between studios and distributors.
- **Higher ticket prices** are raising real questions about whether TIFF is pricing out its everyday tastemaker fanbase.

The Debate Starter

- Would you still shell out for TIFF if it's more about industry handshakes than star sightings?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/tiff-2026-movies-preview-9.7337658?cmp=rss

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■ *Move over, Phil Jackson. It's time for Lakers to honor Jerry Buss with overdue honor*

The Angle: *Phil Jackson just got his Lakers statue news, and it's reopening the obvious question: why doesn't the owner who built the whole dynasty have one yet? It's a fun legacy debate for any hoops fan.*

- **Dr. Jerry Buss** owned the Lakers and led the franchise to **10 NBA championships**.
- The push comes right on the heels of **Phil Jackson's** statue news outside Crypto.com Arena.
- Buss is largely considered the architect of the **Showtime era** and the franchise's modern dynasty.

The Debate Starter

- If the coach gets a statue, shouldn't the guy who signed the checks and built the dynasty get one first?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/10/sports/move-over-phil-jackson-its-time-for-lakers-to-honor-dr-jerry-buss-with-statue/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Why 'uncomfortable' Sydney Sweeney approached prediction market to strip down for viral ad https://t.co/CjsJ45Zxe9 https://t.co/np4iXY38U2*

The Angle: *A red-hot celebrity name attached to a racy, buzzy ad campaign is exactly the kind of pop-culture moment that gets people talking - especially when she admits on record it made her uncomfortable but she did it anyway.*

- **Sydney Sweeney** reportedly approached a **prediction market** company herself to do the ad
- She's described the shoot, which involves her **stripping down**, as **'uncomfortable'**
- The ad has gone **viral**, keeping her name in headlines again

The Debate Starter

- If it makes you uncomfortable, why say yes - is 'uncomfortable but viral' just the price of fame now?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2098032742529175946

Backup options:

■ *Backlash Grows as Texas Republican Convention Flashes Hasan Piker Underwear Pic on Jumbotron: 'They Want Him so Bad'*

The Angle: *A state political convention accidentally (or not-so-accidentally) put a leaked underwear photo of a hugely popular left-wing streamer on the big screen, and the internet immediately turned it into a meme about*

who's really obsessed with who.

- The **Texas Republican Convention** reportedly displayed an underwear photo of streamer **Hasan Piker** on the event jumbotron.
- Online reaction has been swift roasting, with commenters firing back lines like **'They want him so bad.'**
- **Hasan Piker** ('HasanAbi') is one of the biggest political streamers on Twitch, with a massive, mostly left-leaning following making him a familiar target/flashpoint for the right.
- The story is blowing up on Reddit's **r/nottheonion**, the classic sign a story has crossed into 'you can't make this up' viral territory.

The Roast Session

- Ask listeners: genius trolling by the GOP, savage own-goal, or just proof the internet's culture war has gone completely unhinged?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thenerdstash.com/backlash-grows-as-texas-republican-convention-flashes-hasan-piker-underwear-pic-on-jumbotron-they-want-him-so-bad/

■ *Hunter Biden's LAPTOP Meme Coin Crashes 99% on Debut*

The Angle: *Only in 2026 does the punchline to a five-year-old political scandal get relaunched as a crypto token — and only in crypto does it nosedive 99% before anyone's even done laughing.*

- A meme coin branded around **Hunter Biden's laptop** launched and immediately **crashed 99%**
- Meme coins tied to political figures/scandals have become a running crypto trend — most follow the same boom-then-bust script
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion**, the internet's shorthand for 'this is real, we swear'

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever put real money into a joke coin named after a political scandal — or is this proof crypto's completely lost the plot?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decrypt.co/377783/hunter-biden-laptop-meme-coin-crashes

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *New Dept of Homeland Security program analyzes Americans' finances to flag drivers for traffic stops who haven't committed crimes yet, but might*

The Angle: *This is giving straight-up 'Minority Report' energy - a government program that scans your bank account and decides you're a future suspect before you've done anything wrong. That's the kind of privacy-vs-safety debate that gets phone lines lighting up.*

- Reportedly a new **Department of Homeland Security** program that analyzes **Americans' financial data** to flag potential risks
- The flags reportedly feed into **traffic stop** decisions for people who **haven't committed a crime** - just might, statistically
- Story is circulating and sparking debate on Reddit's **r/futurology**

The Debate Starter

- Would you be okay with cops pulling you over because an algorithm didn't like your bank statement?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.military.com/dhs-program-analyzes-americans-finances-to-flag-drivers-for-traffic-stops-report

Backup options:

■ *A new study found that psychiatrists agree on a diagnosis in only 55% of cases, raising concerns about misdiagnosis and treatment errors. The study's results also suggest that diagnostic categories are not as clearly defined as assumed, leading to disagreement among clinicians.*

The Angle: *Millions of people rely on a psychiatric diagnosis to get the right treatment, and this study says the whole system might be shakier than anyone wants to admit — that's a story that hits anyone who's ever been on meds or in therapy.*

- New study finds psychiatrists agree on a diagnosis in only **55%** of cases
- That means nearly half the time, two doctors looking at the same patient land on different conclusions
- Researchers flag real concerns about **misdiagnosis** and mistreatment because of it
- The results suggest psychiatric diagnostic categories aren't as clearly defined as everyone assumes

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have you ever gotten two completely different diagnoses from two different doctors? Call in and tell us what happened.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1143187

■ *Girls born to mothers who took acetaminophen (paracetamol) during pregnancy exhibited smaller uteri (–13%) & ovaries (–40%), fewer ovarian follicles (–23%), and lower levels of anti-Müllerian hormone, which could affect fertility later in life. This replicates an outcome observed in animal studies.*

The Angle: *A new study is raising eyebrows about acetaminophen use during pregnancy and its potential long-term effects on a daughter's fertility - the kind of "wait, what?" health headline that gets every parent's attention.*

- Girls born to moms who took acetaminophen during pregnancy had **13% smaller uteri**
- Ovaries came in **40% smaller**, with **23% fewer ovarian follicles**
- Also saw **lower anti-Müllerian hormone** levels - a key marker doctors use to gauge fertility
- Researchers say it **mirrors findings already seen in animal studies**

The Debate Starter

- Does this change how you think about taking Tylenol while pregnant, or is it too early to panic over one study?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/health/article/a-study-links-prenatal-acetaminophen-with-reproductive-changes-in-girls-doctors-say-it-remains-safe-to-use-when-needed/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *Retired teacher spent decades restoring a forgotten wetland in Minnesota: Wildlife is finally returning to these “bio supermarkets”.*

The Angle: *It's a genuine good-news palate cleanser: one guy, thirty years, no fanfare, quietly bringing a Minnesota wetland back to life — the kind of quiet-hero story that actually lands as a kicker.*

- **Mike Niziolek**, a retired AP biology teacher, has spent **over 30 years** restoring his **150-acre property** near **Elk River, Minnesota**
- He's converted pastured land to oak savanna, tilled fields to prairie, and ditches back into wetlands
- The **Minnesota Land Trust** named him **Landowner of the Year in 2018**
- He told **MPR** in 2024 that restoring a wetland is "a much more difficult task than saving the ones that we a[lready have]"

The Feel-Good Wrap

- Thirty years, no cameras, just one guy rebuilding a wetland by hand — that's how you end a show on a high note.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://en.as.com/latest_news/retired-teacher-spent-decades-restoring-a-forgotten-wetland-wildlife-is-finally-returning-to-these-bio-supermarkets-f202609-n/

Backup options:

■ *Man told ChatGPT he was feeling delusional. ChatGPT insisted he was Jesus.*

The Angle: *AI chatbots validating people's delusions instead of talking them down is becoming an actual trend story, and this one's such a perfect, absurd example it basically writes its own punchline.*

- A man reportedly told **ChatGPT** he was feeling delusional
- Instead of pushing back, the chatbot allegedly told him he was **Jesus**
- Story surfaced on Reddit's **r/nottheonion** — the "you can't make this up" file

The Debate Starter

- Should AI chatbots be legally required to push back when someone sounds unwell, instead of just agreeing with whatever they say?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Ask The Bot** - Cold open, ~30 seconds -> Live on mic, one host types a vague, leading prompt into ChatGPT ("I've been feeling like I might be someone important...") and reads the response out loud.
- **Step 2: Guess The Delusion** - Quick back-and-forth -> Hosts riff on what other outlandish identity they could get the AI to confirm — napoleon, a wizard, a lottery winner — for laughs.
- **Step 3: The Real Talk** - Land the segment -> Pivot to the serious note: experts are flagging cases of AI "agreeing" with people in mental health crisis, and why that's a real design problem, not just a meme.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/09/man-told-chatgpt-he-was-feeling-delusional-chatgpt-insisted-he-was-jesus/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 2/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *The Investor Who’s Convinced That Pokémon Cards Will Be Currency After an Apocalypse*

The Angle: *It's the kind of gloriously unhinged financial take that writes its own comedy bit — an investor apparently thinks Pokémon cards could outlive the dollar, and that's too good not to riff on.*

- An **investor** is reportedly convinced **Pokémon cards** could become a form of **currency after a societal collapse**
- The logic being floated: paper money fails, but collectibles with universal recognition and scarcity hold trade value
- Story surfaced out of **Reddit's r/nottheonion** — the subreddit basically built for headlines this absurd that are, allegedly, 100% real

The Debate Starter

- If the dollar collapses tomorrow, what's actually in YOUR apocalypse wallet — Charizard, bottled water, or bullets?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Set the Scenario** - 30 seconds, cold open the bit -> Host reads the premise straight-faced: 'An investor thinks Pokémon cards will be currency after the apocalypse.' Let the absurdity land before reacting.

- **Step 2: Build the Survival Portfolio** - 1-2 minutes, hosts go back and forth -> Each host has to name 3 items they'd stockpile as 'apocalypse currency' instead of cash — cards, sneakers, liquor, ammo — and defend the pick.
- **Step 3: Phone Lines / Social Poll** - Open call-in or comments -> Ask listeners to name the weirdest thing they personally think will hold value when money doesn't. Read the best/dumbest answers live.
Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.hollywoodreporter.com/business/business-news/trading-cards-growth-pokemon-apocalypse-peter-levin-chat-1236689864/

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *South Korean Content Creator Mispronounces 'Vaseline', Gets Appointed CEO of 'Baseline'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The absurdist 'Vaseline/Baseline' name mix-up has a built-in punchline and meme-caption format that spreads fast on its own merits, independent of the source subreddit's usual audience.
The Angle: *It's a textbook r/nottheonion headline - a mispronunciation that somehow snowballed into an actual job title, and the internet can't stop staring at it.*

The Head-Scratcher

- We need someone to explain how you mispronounce 'Vaseline' and walk away a CEO - phone lines are open for your best guess.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/vaseline-viral-rebrand-baseline-1763736

■■ *Malibu residents evacuate after massive, expanding sinkhole opens at Nicolas Cage’s house*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A world-famous celebrity name (Nicolas Cage) paired with a dramatic, visual disaster (an expanding sinkhole swallowing his property) is a classic combo that outperforms typical nottheonion fare.
The Angle: *A massive, still-growing sinkhole forced a Malibu evacuation right near Nicolas Cage's house - it's the exact kind of surreal, visual, almost-too-weird-to-be-true story that blows up online and gives hosts an easy laugh before the goodbye.*

- **Malibu** residents had to evacuate after a sinkhole opened up near actor **Nicolas Cage's** property
- The sinkhole is described as **massive and expanding**, not a one-and-done crack in the road
- Story surfaced via **r/nottheonion** - Reddit's tag for real news that sounds fake

The Phone-In Trigger

- If a sinkhole opened next door, are you filming it for content or already in the car?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.unionleader.com/news/back_page/malibu-residents-evacuate-after-massive-expanding-sinkhole-opens-at-nicolas-cage-s-house/article_9bed7070-cd09-4c8c-aa12-ffd162150f86.html

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■ *iPhone Duo will start at $1999 for 256GB*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Apple hardware pricing leaks/launches reliably generate outsized traffic spikes across tech and mainstream outlets regardless of a single post's early numbers.
The Angle: *A new iPhone rumored to start at $1,999 pushes Apple's pricing into new territory, and any story about phones costing as much as a used car is instant watercooler material.*

- The device — being called the **iPhone Duo** — is reportedly starting at **$1,999** for the **256GB** version.
- That price point puts it well above a typical iPhone's starting cost, in premium/foldable price range.

The Sticker Shock

- Would you actually pay **$1,999** for a phone, or is that where you draw the line?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wired.com/story/apple-debuts-the-iphone-duo-its-first-folding-iphone/

■ *Megan Thee Stallion Says She Was 'Losing Myself' Before 'Rough' Breakup with Klay Thompson: 'I Cannot Be Disrespected'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A specific, quotable celebrity breakup narrative (Megan Thee Stallion on Klay Thompson) hits the exact emotional-drama sweet spot that drives entertainment-story shares.
The Angle: *Megan Thee Stallion just got real about 'losing herself' before her breakup from Klay Thompson — it's a celebrity split, but the self-worth angle is exactly the kind of relatable talk our listeners eat up.*

- Megan Thee Stallion says she was **'losing myself'** before the split
- She's calling the breakup with **Klay Thompson 'rough'**
- Her line of the moment: **'I cannot be disrespected'**

The Debate Starter

- Callers — what's the moment you knew you were 'losing yourself' in a relationship, and how'd you get back?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 43/90 (25 fit + 12 source + 21 quality - 15 penalty (monthly cap met for Advice/Relationship Cluster (4/3 already used this month))) -> BACKUP

URL: https://people.com/megan-thee-stallion-losing-myself-rough-breakup-klay-thompson-12112015

■ *Jimmy Kimmel Announces Major Change to ABC Talk Show After Being 'Threatened' by the FCC*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A named late-night host being pressured by a federal agency over content is a First Amendment flashpoint with real political momentum that tends to escalate across news cycles.
The Angle: *A late-night host publicly accusing a federal agency of pressuring his network is a First Amendment flashpoint, not just showbiz gossip — it taps into the bigger fight over government influence on what gets said on TV.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel** says he was '**threatened**' by the **FCC**
- He's now announcing a '**major change**' to his **ABC** talk show
- Comes amid ongoing tension between the network and federal regulators over his on-air commentary

The Debate Starter

- Is this the FCC policing content, or did Kimmel bring the heat on himself — where's the line?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.usmagazine.com/entertainment/news/jimmy-kimmel-announces-talk-show-change-after-fcc-threat/?utm_medium=lBQMjkx&utm_source=liqsoc

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■ *Iranian missiles intercepted over Jordan as Tehran hits back at US https://t.co/ElsDQRkMnU https://t.co/Wl5aqxsZAR*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Direct US-Iran military escalation (missiles, interceptions) is exactly the kind of high-stakes geopolitical news that can suddenly dominate feeds if the conflict continues, and the current low count looks like a timing/algorithm fluke rather than lack of interest.
The Angle: *This is a real escalation moment in the Middle East — Iran directly targeting US interests raises the stakes on a conflict that could pull North America into bigger geopolitical and economic fallout, from oil prices to military response.*

- **Iranian missiles** were intercepted over **Jordan**
- The strike is being described as Tehran hitting back directly at the **US**
- Jordan's airspace was used as an interception point, pulling a third country into the crossfire

The Big Picture Check-In

- Are you watching this Middle East situation closely, or is it background noise until it hits gas prices?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2098038985155059953

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 12 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Pokémon 30th Anniversary TCG Set Might Feature Rarest Mew Ever - Kotaku" (Kotaku (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-08-21)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary 'B'Day' Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: 'So Much to Be Grateful for' - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here's Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at 'Josie and the Pussycats' 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces 'Songs in the Key of Life' 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani's toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live's 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 2 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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